Workplace Behaviour (MB333A) – Unit I Assignment Answers

S.Y. B.Tech (AI & DS) · Simple-language version · 5 marks each

Q1. Apply the concept of Workplace Behaviour to a workplace situation covering its scope and importance.

Meaning in simple words: Workplace Behaviour (WB) means studying how people act at work, alone and in groups, and using that understanding to help them do better work.

Situation: A new project team in a software company keeps missing deadlines. The manager does not just say "they have a bad attitude". He looks for the real reasons at three levels.

Scope (what WB covers):

- **Individual level:** one person's nature, thinking, feelings and motivation. *Example:* one member is not confident with a new tool.
- **Group level:** how people work together: roles, communication, leadership, conflict. *Example:* nobody knows who does what, and meetings are irregular.
- **Organization level:** company rules, structure and culture. *Example:* priorities keep changing.

Action taken: The manager gives tool training (individual), fixes roles and a weekly meeting (group), and asks top management to keep priorities steady (organization).

Importance:

- It helps us understand why people behave in a certain way.
- It improves performance, satisfaction and teamwork.
- It reduces conflict and employees leaving the job.
- It helps managers decide using facts, not guesses.

Diagram: Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organization Context → Work Behaviour → Performance & Satisfaction

Conclusion: Work gets done through people. If managers understand people, they can solve problems properly and get better results.

Q2. Apply the theoretical framework of Workplace Behaviour to a situation involving individual and group behaviour.

Framework in simple words: Behaviour at work depends on three connected levels: the individual, the group and the organization. Together they decide how well people perform and how satisfied they feel.

Situation: In a design department, one employee is quiet and withdrawn, and the whole team does not coordinate well with the testing team.

Individual behaviour (about the person):

- *Perception* (how he sees things): he feels his ideas are ignored.

- *Attitude* (his feelings about work): low satisfaction, so less effort.
- *Individual differences:* his need for recognition is different from others.

Group behaviour (about the team):

- Roles are not clear, so work is repeated or missed.
- *Norms* (unwritten team rules) discourage speaking up.
- Communication with other teams is poor, so delays happen.

Organization effect: Frequent deadline changes and no proper feedback system add pressure.

Action: The manager first collects facts by talking and observing. Then she gives feedback and recognition, clears the roles, sets meeting rules that welcome everyone's opinion, and reports the deadline issue to higher management.

Diagram: Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organization Context → Work Behaviour → Outcome

Result: Participation and coordination improve. So individual and group behaviour are linked, and a manager should find the cause first and then act.

Q3. Apply the S-O-B-C model to a suitable workplace situation covering all four components.

Model in simple words: S-O-B-C explains what happens after something occurs at work. Something happens (S), the person thinks about it in their own way (O), they act (B), and the result of that action (C) decides whether they repeat it.

Situation: An IT company announces a bonus and public appreciation for teams that solve urgent customer problems on time.

The four parts:

- **Stimulus (S):** the event or trigger. Here, the bonus and appreciation announcement.
- **Organism (O):** the employee's inner side: how they understand it, their feelings, expectations and past experience. One developer thinks the target is fair and feels motivated. Another thinks it is pressure and feels worried.
- **Behaviour (B):** what the person actually does. The motivated developer talks early with the testing team and finishes the fix on time.
- **Consequence (C):** what follows the action. The manager praises the team, the customer is happy and the bonus is paid.

Why it matters: Because the result is good, the employee will likely repeat the same behaviour. If good work was ignored, the habit would fade.

Diagram: Stimulus → Employee's Thinking (Organism) → Behaviour → Consequence → Future Behaviour

Manager's use: Explain rules clearly, check how employees understand them, and give rewards that encourage the right behaviour.

Conclusion: S-O-B-C helps managers understand and guide behaviour step by step.

Q4. Apply any two models of Workplace Behaviour to a suitable managerial situation.

Models in simple words: Models are different styles of managing, based on what a manager believes about employees. The four are autocratic, custodial, supportive and collegial. Here I use two: **Autocratic** and **Supportive**.

Situation: In a factory, the production line stops suddenly. The manager must restore it fast and later prevent it from happening again.

1. Autocratic model (manager gives orders)

- Idea: the manager has the power and employees follow instructions.
- Use: during the breakdown, the manager clearly tells each person what to do, because time is short.
- Result: quick action and control. But if used all the time, employees become dependent and less involved.

2. Supportive model (manager helps and encourages)

- Idea: the manager's job is to help employees do their best.
- Use: after the repair, the manager listens to the engineers, thanks them and asks for ideas to avoid the problem.
- Result: employees feel motivated and take responsibility.

Judgement: The manager checks how urgent the work is and how skilled the team is. Emergencies need clear orders; improvement needs support.

Diagram: Situation → Manager's Belief → Chosen Model → Employee Response → Outcome

Conclusion: No model is best everywhere. A good manager changes style as the situation changes.

Q5. A team shows low participation after a change in work rules. Apply the S-O-B-C model considering possible causes and consequences.

Situation: A company changes its reporting rules without asking the team. After that, people take less part in meetings and tasks.

Using S-O-B-C:

- **Stimulus:** the sudden new reporting rule, with no discussion.
- **Organism (inner thinking):** employees may feel the rule is unfair, may think management does not trust them, may be afraid of making mistakes, or may simply be confused about what is expected.
- **Behaviour:** low participation: silence in meetings, minimum effort, late reports, maybe more absence.
- **Consequence:** work quality and coordination fall, and employees become more unhappy. If the manager only scolds them, the withdrawal grows.

Possible causes: no consultation, unclear reason for the change, fear of failure, extra work, loss of freedom.

Solution:

1. Talk to employees to know how they see the rule.
2. Explain why the rule is needed and what is expected.
3. Change the rule if their feedback is reasonable.
4. Appreciate good participation so it continues.

Diagram: New Rule (S) → Unfair / Fear Feeling (O) → Low Participation (B) → Unhappiness & Poor Output (C) → More Withdrawal

Conclusion: Fixing the trigger and understanding employees' feelings works better than blaming them.

Q6. Apply the scope of Workplace Behaviour to an organization facing poor coordination and declining employee involvement.

Scope in simple words: Scope means the areas WB covers: individual behaviour, group behaviour, organization-level factors, and the results such as performance and satisfaction.

Situation: In a medium-sized company, departments work separately, deadlines are missed and employees show less interest.

Analysis and action:

- **Individual level:** employees feel their work is not noticed, so they lose motivation. *Action:* give regular feedback and recognition; give work that suits their skills.
- **Group level:** roles overlap, departments do not talk, and there is no common goal. *Action:* define roles, set shared targets and hold joint meetings.
- **Organization level:** the structure is too rigid, policies are unclear, and employees are not asked for opinions. *Action:* simplify reporting, clarify policies and start a suggestion system.

Expected results: better coordination, more involvement, less absence, better quality.

Diagram: Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organization Context → Work Behaviour → Better Coordination & Involvement

Managerial point: A problem that looks personal may come from the team or the organization, so the manager should find the real cause first.

Conclusion: WB's wide scope helps managers see the whole picture and improve both behaviour and results.

Q7. Apply the concept of Workplace Behaviour to a situation involving employees, managers and the organization.

Concept in simple words: WB looks at how employees behave, how managers act and what kind of environment the organization gives, and how these three affect each other and the results.

Situation: In a service company, customer complaints are increasing and employees say that management does not listen to them.

Role of each:

- **Employees:** their attitude, skills and motivation decide service quality. Here, they are tired of heavy workload and lack of feedback.
- **Managers:** they guide, communicate and appreciate. Here, the manager only gives orders and rarely listens.
- **Organization:** its rules, culture and systems. Here, targets are too high and the software is outdated.

Action: Employees get training and feedback. The manager holds regular discussions and listens. The organization makes targets realistic and upgrades its tools.

Diagram: Employees ↔ Managers ↔ Organization → Work Behaviour → Performance & Satisfaction

Result: Employees feel heard, complaints reduce and customers become happier.

Conclusion: Behaviour at work is not caused by employees alone. Good results need all three to work together, and managers should find causes before deciding.

Q8. Apply the major models of Workplace Behaviour to a situation involving different assumptions about employees.

Models in simple words: A model is a management style. Each style rests on a belief about employees. The four are autocratic, custodial, supportive and collegial.

Situation: A technology company has a factory, a payroll department and a software team. The manager must manage each one suitably.

The four models:

- **Autocratic (power):** belief: employees need orders. Used for strict safety rules in the factory. *Drawback:* employees become dependent and show little initiative.
- **Custodial (money and security):** belief: employees want security. Used through salary, insurance and benefits. *Drawback:* people feel safe but not very motivated.
- **Supportive (leadership):** belief: employees want to grow and be appreciated. Used when team leaders coach and praise. *Result:* motivation and involvement.
- **Collegial (partnership):** belief: employees are responsible and self-disciplined. Used when the software team plans and reviews work together. *Result:* teamwork and ownership.

Judgement: No model is best everywhere. The manager looks at urgency, skill level and how much teamwork is needed. One company can use more than one model.

Diagram: Manager's Belief → Chosen Model → Leadership Practice → Employee Response → Outcome

Conclusion: Models are tools for choosing the right working climate for each situation.

Q9. A manager introduces recognition for timely project completion. Apply the S-O-B-C model.

Situation: An IT project manager announces that teams finishing milestones on time will be praised publicly in the monthly meeting.

Using S-O-B-C:

- **Stimulus (S):** the new recognition scheme for finishing on time.
- **Organism (O):** how employees take it. Those who value recognition and find the targets fair feel encouraged. Others who think the rules are unclear or biased may not care.
- **Behaviour (B):** motivated teams plan better, coordinate with other teams, solve problems quickly and finish milestones on time.
- **Consequence (C):** public praise, positive feedback and a good name for the team. Quality and client satisfaction also improve.

Reinforcement (making behaviour stronger): Since the praise is valued and comes after the good behaviour, employees will likely repeat it. If praise came late or unfairly, the effect would be weak.

Manager should:

1. Keep the rules clear and fair.
2. Give recognition soon after the work.
3. Ask for feedback to know how employees feel.
4. Make sure shortcuts are not rewarded by mistake.

Diagram: Recognition Scheme → Employee's Thinking → Timely Completion → Praise → Repeated Behaviour

Conclusion: A fair trigger, a positive understanding and a valued result together build lasting good behaviour.

Q10. Apply Workplace Behaviour concepts to improve teamwork in a newly formed project group.

Situation: A new project group misses deadlines because members do not know their duties, talk irregularly and do not yet know each other well.

Concepts used (in simple words):

- **Roles:** write down each person's duties so work is not repeated or missed.
- **Norms:** agree on simple team rules such as meeting times and how fast to reply to messages.
- **Communication:** hold a short daily or weekly meeting and use a common chat group for updates.
- **Cooperation and trust:** give shared goals and tasks that depend on each other, and organise small team activities so members rely on one another.
- **Leadership:** the leader guides, solves small conflicts early and appreciates the whole team.
- **Individual needs:** give training to those unsure about a tool and match tasks to skills.

Expected result: clear roles and rules improve communication; good communication builds cooperation; cooperation improves team performance.

Diagram: Team Situation → Roles & Norms → Communication → Cooperation → Team Performance

Example: After a kick-off meeting that fixes duties and a weekly review, the group starts meeting its milestones.

Conclusion: Teamwork does not happen by itself. A manager who clears roles, sets rules and encourages talking turns a group of individuals into a real team.

Q11. Apply individual-level Workplace Behaviour concepts to an employee showing low motivation.

Situation: A capable employee who once worked with interest now shows low motivation because his repeated efforts get no feedback or recognition.

Individual-level concepts (in simple words):

- **Perception (how he sees things):** he feels his work is unnoticed, even if the manager did not mean it that way.
- **Attitude (his feeling about the job):** satisfaction has dropped, so effort and enthusiasm have dropped.
- **Needs and motivation:** his need for recognition and achievement is not met. Meeting it can bring back his energy.
- **Individual differences:** every person is different in nature and expectations, so the manager must understand him personally.
- **Learning:** useful feedback and appreciation help him repeat good work.

Manager's action:

1. Talk privately and listen to find the real reason.
2. Give regular, specific feedback and appreciate achievements.
3. Set clear, achievable goals and offer growth chances like training.
4. Check progress and keep encouraging.

Diagram: Perception & Attitude → Unmet Needs → Low Motivation → Feedback & Recognition → Better Performance

Conclusion: Low motivation usually has a reason. By understanding it, the manager can bring back the employee's interest instead of calling him careless.

Q12. Apply group-level Workplace Behaviour concepts to resolve conflict between two teams.

Situation: The development team and the testing team blame each other for delays. They hardly talk, and cooperation has stopped.

Likely causes: unclear duties, different aims (speed versus quality), poor communication, fight for resources, and a bad opinion of each other.

Group-level concepts used:

- **Shared goal:** give both teams one common aim, such as delivering a good product on time, so they need each other.
- **Clear roles:** decide who does which task and when work is handed over, so blame reduces.
- **Communication:** joint review meetings, a shared tracking tool and direct talks clear misunderstandings.
- **Leadership:** the manager acts as a neutral helper, listens to both sides and talks about the problem, not the people.
- **Trust and cooperation:** joint activities and rewarding combined success bring the teams closer.

Diagram: Conflict → Common Goal & Clear Roles → Proper Communication → Cooperation → Team Performance

Result: Blame turns into problem solving, delays reduce and relations improve.

Conclusion: Conflict between teams can be managed. Shared goals, clear roles and open talk change conflict into cooperation.

Q13. Apply the supportive model of Workplace Behaviour to improve employee involvement.

Supportive model in simple words: The manager acts like a helper and coach. The belief is that employees want to contribute if they are encouraged and given good conditions. The aim is motivation, participation and better performance.

Situation: In a software team, involvement is falling because the project manager controls every task and rarely asks for opinions.

How to apply:

- **Coaching:** the manager guides and develops people instead of only controlling them.
- **Feedback and recognition:** regular useful feedback and thanks raise morale.
- **Participation:** ask team members for ideas while planning and solving problems, so they feel it is their work too.
- **Support:** give training, tools and a friendly climate where mistakes are used for learning.

Employee response: employees feel trusted and valued, take initiative and become more committed and satisfied.

Limitation: It needs capable employees and some time. In an emergency, firm instructions may still be needed.

Diagram: Falling Involvement → Supportive Leadership → Coaching, Recognition, Participation → Motivated Employees → Better Performance

Conclusion: The supportive model raises involvement because the manager changes from controller to supporter.

Q14. Apply the collegial model of Workplace Behaviour to a self-managed technical team.

Collegial model in simple words: The manager treats employees as partners. The belief is that skilled people can take responsibility and manage themselves. It works best with experienced, capable teams.

Situation: A self-managed product team of engineers plans together, reviews each other's work and shares responsibility. The manager only facilitates (helps things run smoothly).

How to apply:

- **Shared planning:** members together decide tasks, priorities and timelines.
- **Peer review:** team members check each other's work and keep each other accountable, so quality does not depend on close supervision.
- **Self-discipline:** members manage their own time and promises because they feel the product is theirs.
- **Manager as facilitator:** the manager removes obstacles, arranges resources and helps solve conflicts rather than giving orders.

Employee response: a feeling of partnership, high commitment, creativity and responsibility.

Limitation: It needs skilled members, clear goals and trust. In a crisis or with new staff, some direction may be needed.

Diagram: Self-managed Team → Partnership Climate → Shared Planning & Peer Review → Self-discipline → High Performance

Conclusion: The collegial model suits technical teams because it uses their skills and builds responsibility, giving quality and new ideas with less control.

Q15. Apply the S-O-B-C model to improve punctuality in a workplace.

Situation: A service firm has many late arrivals, so it starts a monthly recognition (certificate and appreciation) for employees who come on time.

Using S-O-B-C:

- **Stimulus (S):** the announcement of monthly recognition for punctuality.
- **Organism (O):** how employees take it. Those who find it fair and achievable accept it and expect their effort to be noticed. If the rule ignores genuine problems like transport delays, some may resist it.
- **Behaviour (B):** employees plan their travel better, leave earlier and reach on time; late coming reduces.
- **Consequence (C):** punctual employees get appreciation from the manager and colleagues, and work runs smoothly. This good result strengthens the habit.

To keep it going:

1. Keep the rule fair and explain its purpose.
2. Give recognition regularly and quickly.
3. Listen to genuine reasons behind lateness.
4. Do not let late coming go unnoticed.

Diagram: Recognition Scheme → Employee's Thinking → Reaching on Time → Appreciation → Repeated Punctuality

Conclusion: Punctuality improves best when a fair rule is understood positively and followed by a valued result, which works better than blame or punishment.

References: K. Aswathappa, *Organizational Behavior*; S. P. Robbins, *Organisational Behaviour*; F. Luthans, *Organisational Behaviour*; Robbins, Judge & Vohra, *Organizational Behavior*, 16th ed.; Robbins & Coulter, *Management*, 13th ed.